

Garlic Parmesan Sauce (Vegetarian & Vegan-Friendly Options)

A creamy garlic sauce that works beautifully with pasta, roasted vegetables, cauliflower steaks, zucchini noodles, grilled paneer, or low-carb casseroles. This version includes both vegetarian Parmesan options and a fully vegan alternative.

Classic Vegetarian Version

- 6 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 ounce vegetarian Parmesan cheese (microbial rennet version)
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter
- 2 tbsp almond flour
- 1 1/2 cups half-and-half or whole milk
- 1/2 cup vegetable broth
- 1/2 tsp kosher salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper

Vegan Alternative Version

- 6 garlic cloves, minced
- 3 tbsp nutritional yeast
- 1 tbsp almond flour
- 1 tbsp vegan butter or olive oil
- 1 1/2 cups unsweetened almond milk or cashew milk
- 1/2 cup vegetable broth
- 1 tbsp soaked blended cashews OR 1 tbsp dairy-free cream cheese (optional for richness)
- 1/2 tsp kosher salt
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- Optional: 1 tsp lemon juice for brightness

Instructions

- Mince the garlic finely.
- Melt butter (or vegan butter/oil) in a skillet over medium heat.

- Add garlic and sauté about 30 seconds until fragrant.
- Add almond flour and stir continuously until absorbed.
- Cook for 30–60 seconds to remove raw flour taste.
- Slowly add milk and vegetable broth while stirring.
- Bring to a gentle simmer.
- Add Parmesan cheese OR nutritional yeast mixture.
- Simmer 2–3 minutes until sauce thickens and coats the back of a spoon.
- Adjust salt and pepper to taste.

Flavor Boosters

- Pinch of mustard powder for deeper cheesy flavor
- Tiny amount of white miso for umami depth
- Extra black pepper
- Fresh parsley
- Pinch of Italian seasoning
- Small squeeze of lemon juice

Low-Carb Tweaks

- Use heavy cream diluted with water instead of milk for lower carbs.
- Add 1 tbsp cream cheese for extra richness.
- Use cashew milk instead of oat milk in vegan version.
- Reduce broth slightly for thicker sauce.

Serving Suggestions

- Zucchini noodles
- Roasted broccoli or cauliflower
- Mushroom steaks
- Paneer or tofu
- Low-carb pasta
- Baked vegetables
- Chickpea idli toasties

Approximate Nutrition — Vegetarian Version (Per Serving)

- Calories: ~140–170
- Protein: ~5–7g
- Net Carbs: ~4–6g
- Fat: ~11–13g

Approximate Nutrition — Vegan Version (Per Serving)

- Calories: ~110–140
- Protein: ~3–5g
- Net Carbs: ~3–5g
- Fat: ~9–11g

Storage & Reheating

- Store refrigerated up to 4 days.
- Reheat gently over low heat.
- Add splash of milk if sauce thickens too much.
- Not ideal for freezing due to texture changes.